

Right to Information (RTI) Application to the Maharashtra State Government Department of Water Supply and Sanitation

To:

The Public Information Officer,
Department of Water Supply and Sanitation,
Government of Maharashtra

Subject: Request for Detailed Information on Water Distribution, Sewage Management, and Private Water Tankers in Maharashtra

Dear Sir/Madam,

Under the Right to Information (RTI) Act, 2005, I am seeking detailed information regarding the current state of water supply, sewage management, and the role of private entities in Maharashtra, specifically in PCMC. This request aims to uncover critical gaps in infrastructure, cyber-physical systems, and the role of privatization in water governance.

Section 1: Water Distribution and Supply Infrastructure

1. Ward-wise Water Distribution Data

- Provide water supply schedules for each ward in PCMC for the last five years.
- Specify the daily allocation (in MLD) and shortfalls encountered.
- Highlight planned versus actual water supply.

2. Non-Revenue Water (NRW) Reports

- Provide records of NRW, including leakages, theft, and billing inefficiencies.
- What percentage of total water supply is unaccounted for, and what steps are being taken to mitigate it?

3. Infrastructure Mapping and Cyber-Physical Water Systems

- Provide a list of operational and defunct pipelines, along with their last maintenance records.
 - Are there any SCADA, IoT, or AI-based systems implemented for water distribution? If so, provide their audit reports.
 - What is the extent of digitization in Maharashtra's water governance, and how is cybersecurity ensured?
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Section 2: Sewage Treatment and Management

4. Sewage Treatment Plants (STPs) and Their Operational Status

- Provide the list of STPs in PCMC and their capacities.
- Specify compliance levels with CPCB and MPCB environmental norms.
- Share operational reports on efficiency and treatment quality over the last three years.

5. Untreated Wastewater and Discharge Locations

- How much untreated sewage is released into rivers or open spaces?
- Provide a breakdown of STP coverage versus uncovered areas.

6. Planned Upgrades and PPP Models in Sewage Management

- Are there ongoing or proposed projects involving private players in sewage treatment?
 - Provide tender documents or agreements with third-party contractors.
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Section 3: Private Water Tankers and Water Extraction

7. List of Registered Private Water Tankers

- Provide a comprehensive list of all private water tankers operating in PCMC.
- Mention their sources of extraction (borewells, rivers, reservoirs) and licensing details.

8. Groundwater Extraction and Privatization Trends

- How many private entities have permits for groundwater extraction in Maharashtra?
- Provide a breakdown of industrial, commercial, and residential usage.

9. Water Pricing and Revenue Collection

- Provide tariff structures for public water supply versus private water distribution.
 - What percentage of water supply revenue is lost due to non-payment or unauthorized connections?
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Section 4: Smart Water Infrastructure and Technology Deployment

10. Smart Metering and Water Monitoring Initiatives

- What percentage of water supply connections have smart meters?
- Provide reports on metering efficiency and digital billing mechanisms.

11. Cybersecurity Measures for Water Infrastructure

- Have there been any reported cyberattacks or vulnerabilities in Maharashtra's water SCADA systems?
- Provide details on security audits conducted in the last three years.

Section 5: Policies, Governance, and Future Planning

12. Public-Private Partnerships (PPPs) in Water Management

- Provide copies of PPP agreements related to water supply, treatment, and distribution.
- What safeguards exist to prevent excessive privatization of water resources?

13. State and Central Funding for Water Projects

- Provide records of Maharashtra's budget allocation for water infrastructure over the past five years.
- Are there any pending World Bank or IMF-funded water projects?

14. Water Scarcity and Climate Change Impact Studies

- Provide reports or studies assessing how climate change affects Maharashtra's water availability.
 - What measures are being implemented to address drought-prone regions?
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Mode of Response

I request the information in **soft copy format (PDFs/scanned documents)**, sent via email or available for physical inspection. If any information is exempt under the RTI Act, kindly specify the relevant clause for rejection.

Sincerely,

Yashraj Wadalkar

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